

问题：证明

$$\cos \frac{4\pi}{7} = \sqrt{\frac{7}{6}} \left[\sqrt{3} \sin \left(\frac{1}{3} \arccos \frac{1}{2\sqrt{7}} \right) - \cos \left(\frac{1}{3} \arccos \frac{1}{2\sqrt{7}} \right) \right] - \frac{1}{6}$$

证明. 令上式右端为 x , $\theta = \frac{1}{3} \arccos \frac{1}{2\sqrt{7}}$, 则

$$x = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{6} \left(\sqrt{3} \sin \theta - \cos \theta \right) - \frac{1}{6} = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{3} \sin \left(\theta - \frac{\pi}{6} \right) - \frac{1}{6}$$

上式使用了辅助角公式, 令 $\vartheta = \theta - \frac{\pi}{6}$, 得到

$$\cos(3\theta) = \cos \left(3\vartheta + \frac{\pi}{2} \right) = -\sin(3\vartheta) = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{7}}$$

同时也解出 $\sin \vartheta = \frac{3}{\sqrt{7}} \left(x + \frac{1}{6} \right)$. 利用三倍角公式

$$\sin(3\vartheta) = 3 \sin \vartheta - 4 \sin^3 \vartheta$$

全部代入后得到 x 所满足的方程:

$$\implies 8x^3 + 4x^2 - 4x - 1 = 0$$

下面验证, $\cos \frac{2\pi}{7}, \cos \frac{4\pi}{7}, \cos \frac{6\pi}{7}$ 是上述三次方程的三个根 (即 x 为三者之一).

令 $\varphi = \frac{2\pi}{7}, \frac{4\pi}{7}, \frac{6\pi}{7}$, 即 $(e^{i\varphi})^7 = 1$, 令 $\zeta = e^{i\varphi} \neq 1$, 因式分解

$$\zeta^7 - 1 = (\zeta - 1)(1 + \zeta + \zeta^2 + \zeta^3 + \zeta^4 + \zeta^5 + \zeta^6)$$

得到

$$1 + \zeta + \zeta^2 + \zeta^3 + \zeta^4 + \zeta^5 + \zeta^6 = 0$$

对上式除以 ζ^3 ,

$$\zeta^{-3} + \zeta^{-2} + \zeta^{-1} + 1 + \zeta^1 + \zeta^2 + \zeta^3 = 0 \quad (\star)$$

令 $t = \zeta + \zeta^{-1} = 2 \cos \varphi$, 则

$$t^2 - 2 = \zeta^2 + \zeta^{-2}$$

$$t^3 - 3t = \zeta^3 + \zeta^{-3}$$

一并代入 $(\star)$

$$\implies t^3 + t^2 - 2t - 1 = 0$$

而 $t = 2x$, 所以

$$8x^3 + 4x^2 - 4x - 1 = 0$$

回到开始的部分, $\theta = \frac{1}{3} \arccos \frac{1}{2\sqrt{7}} \in \left(0, \frac{\pi}{6}\right), \sin \left(\theta - \frac{\pi}{6}\right) \in \left(-\frac{1}{2}, 0\right)$, 由此推得 $x = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{3} \sin \left(\theta - \frac{\pi}{6}\right) - \frac{1}{6} \in \left(-\frac{\sqrt{7}+1}{6}, -\frac{1}{6}\right)$.

进一步放缩,

$$\cos \frac{6\pi}{7} < \cos \frac{3\pi}{4} < -\frac{1+\sqrt{7}}{6} < x < -\frac{1}{6} < \cos \frac{2\pi}{7}$$

原式 x 只能是 $\cos \frac{4\pi}{7}$

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